

5.2 E-Mail

Outlook Express is the e-mail client and news-group reader that comes by default with XP.



Outlook Express—the e-mail client in Windows XP

Many users are confused between Microsoft Outlook Express and Microsoft Outlook, believing them to be the same software. But these are two entirely different software. Both Outlook and Outlook Express handle the basics of e-mail, including an address book, message rules, user-created folders, and support for POP3, IMAP, and HTTP mail accounts. However, that's where the similarity ends. Both programs were designed with different audiences in mind.

Outlook Express was developed as part of Internet Explorer with the home user in mind, while Outlook was developed as part of Microsoft Office with the corporate user in mind. Outlook Express is a basic e-mail client that is part of Internet Explorer and Windows. Outlook is a full-featured personal information manager (PIM) that is available as a part of Microsoft Office and also as a standalone program.

Outlook Express handles not only Internet mail but also Internet news, a feature that Outlook does not natively possess. But Outlook has a host of features that Outlook Express does not have, such as a calendar, a task list, a journal, and automatic backup into archive files.

Outlook 2003 also has a very powerful “Junk Mail” feature and message rules for both incoming and outgoing mail, while Outlook Express can only filter incoming mail. Let's learn how to get started with e-mail using Microsoft Outlook Express.